

February

4

1945

Yalta Conference

Three leaders – British prime minister Winston Churchill, US president Franklin D Roosevelt, and Soviet leader Joseph Stalin – met at the Yalta Conference in the Soviet Union to decide the future of Europe after World War II.



1993

Znamya satellite

Russian scientists reflected a brief flash of sunlight over the night skies of Europe using a mirror on the Znamya satellite. This was a test to see whether they could increase daylight hours on Earth.



Born this day

1868 Constance Georgine Markievicz, Irish countess. She was the first woman elected as a member of the British parliament.

1918 Ida Lupino, British film actor. She played many inspiring roles in Hollywood before becoming one of the first women to direct a film.

Also on this day

960 Zhao Kuangyin was crowned Taizu, the first emperor of the Song Dynasty. This marked the start of three centuries of Song rule in southern China.

1938 Disney's *Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs* – the first full-length animated feature film – was released, and went on to become a huge box-office hit.

2004 Mark Zuckerberg launched a social networking site for Harvard University students. This was Facebook, now a social media giant.

1936

Synthetic radium

Radium, the radioactive metal found in some rocks, was produced artificially by US scientist John J Livingood – the first time an element had been created synthetically.

